



NCCA

An Chomhairle Náisiúnta
Curaclaim agus Measúnachta
National Council for
Curriculum and Assessment

Guidelines to support the Applied Geography Project

December 2025

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Introduction

This document, *Guidelines to support the Applied Geography Project* provides:

- details of the nature and scope of the Leaving Certificate Geography Additional Assessment Component (AAC), the Applied Geography Project, as outlined in the curriculum specification
- guidance for schools, teachers and students on undertaking, completing and submitting the Applied Geography Project
- information on the role of schools and teachers in supporting students with the AAC
- descriptors of quality for the Applied Geography Project.

These guidelines should be used in conjunction with the curriculum specification for Leaving Certificate Geography which can be accessed at <https://www.curriculumonline.ie/senior-cycle/senior-cycle-subjects/geography/>.

A brief for the Applied Geography Project will be published annually by the State Examinations Commission (SEC) in term 2 of year 1.

Assessment for Certification in Leaving Certificate Geography

Assessment for certification is based on the rationale, aim and learning outcomes of the Leaving Certificate Geography specification. There are two assessment components: a written examination and an additional assessment component comprising an Applied Geography Project. The written examination will be at higher and ordinary level. The Applied Geography Project will be based on a common brief and will be assessed at the level at which the student sits the final written examination. Each component will be set and examined by the State Examinations Commission (SEC).

Table 1: Overview of assessment for certification

Assessment component	Weighting	Level
Applied Geography Project	40%	Common brief
Written examination	60%	Higher and Ordinary levels

Overview of the Applied Geography Project

The Applied Geography Project provides an opportunity for students to demonstrate evidence of their learning from across the specification, that is, to apply and showcase the learning set out in the Unifying Strand in the context of one or more of the three contextual strands. The senior cycle key competencies and geographical skills, embedded in the learning throughout Leaving Certificate Geography, will be applied through the students' engagement with the Applied Geography Project.

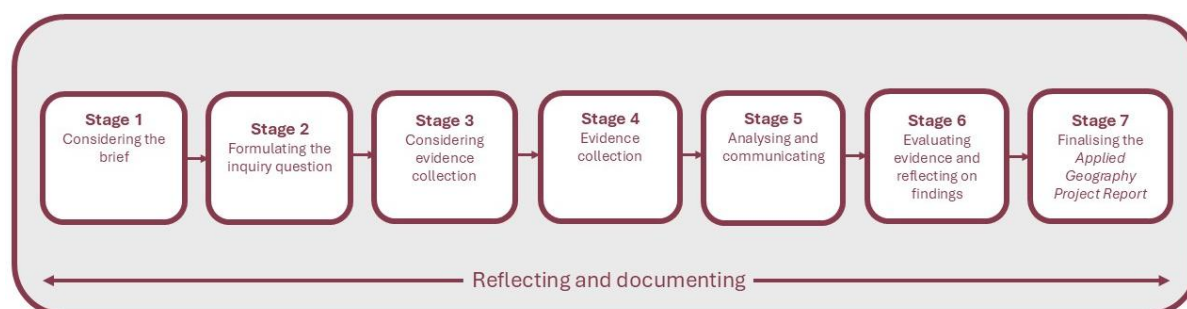
The Applied Geography Project is designed to naturally integrate into the flow of teaching and learning, exploiting its potential to be motivating for students. Engagement with the Applied Geography Project also supports students to see the relevance of geography in their lives. To complete the Applied Geography Project, students will conduct an inquiry in line with the contents and requirements of the common brief. This will involve completing research into an area related to the contents of the brief. They will plan and carry out their inquiry. They will gather and analyse data which will contribute to their learning and facilitate them to draw and communicate informed conclusions. It is envisaged that the Applied Geography Project will take up to 20 hours to complete. Whilst students may work with others in carrying out specific tasks associated with their Applied Geography Project, their evidence of learning is submitted and assessed individually.

Students complete their Applied Geography Project in response to the common brief issued annually by the State Examinations Commission (SEC). As well as setting out the specific requirements of the Applied Geography Project, the brief:

- will support students in considering areas related to the brief which they may wish to explore
- will support teachers in planning for learning and teaching
- may support students in gathering resources which they may draw upon as they complete their Applied Geography Project.

Upon completion, students will produce an individual *Applied Geography Project Report* in a format prescribed by the SEC.

The Applied Geography Project is comprised of seven stages in a geographical inquiry process, as outlined in the Unifying Strand. Students will engage with these stages to complete their Applied Geography Project and produce their *Applied Geography Project Report*.



Process for the completion of the Applied Geography Project

The Applied Geography Project is designed to naturally integrate into everyday teaching and learning and to provide opportunities for students to better understand the world around them. The integration and application of the learning outlined in the Unifying Strand throughout their study of Leaving Certificate Geography means that students have frequent opportunities to develop knowledge, skills, values and dispositions relevant for the completion of the Applied Geography Project. Throughout their engagement with Leaving Certificate Geography, students learn about geographical inquiry as a process and how to plan and conduct geographical inquiries. By the time the students begin their Applied Geography Project, they should have had opportunities to encounter and participate in a variety of geographical inquiries, through learning both in and beyond the classroom, including when conducting fieldwork. The Applied Geography Project provides an opportunity for students to engage with the geography of their local area. Students are strongly encouraged to consider how the theme outlined in the brief from the SEC presents itself in the geography of their local area when choosing the focus or setting of their Applied Geography Project.

Students will engage with seven stages to complete their Applied Geography Project and produce their *Applied Geography Project Report*. Indicative times for the completion of each stage are included in the relevant section for each stage (below). However, the time needed for each stage will depend on the nature of the brief in any given year and the approach chosen by the student. As stated in the specification, schools have a high degree of autonomy in planning and organising the completion of the project. It is not necessary for students to complete all stages of the project in one continuous block, rather the various stages may occur at different times during the broad window for completion. The timing of the release of the brief by the SEC, along with the broad window of completion, allows teachers and students to plan for engagement with the Applied Geography Project in a manner that integrates with the student experience of learning outcomes in the specification.

In carrying out and reporting on their Applied Geography Project, students will apply geographical thinking and skills. Within the context of their interpretation and treatment of the brief, it is important that students focus on outlining the decisions they make at each stage. Throughout, they should keep ethics, safety and sustainability in mind, and in their reporting demonstrate how these impact on their decision-making. While students may collaborate with others in carrying out specific activities in the evidence collection stage (stage 5), all other stages must be individual to each student, and their *Applied Geography Project Report* will be submitted and assessed individually.

It is possible that projects will not go as planned or students will not realise their expected findings. This should be regarded as an opportunity for reflection and documentation of decision-making.

Assessment of the Applied Geography Project is based solely on the students' individual *Applied Geography Project Report*. It is recommended that students keep an inquiry log to record their

progress and reflections through the project stages. The inquiry log will be useful in generating their final *Applied Geography Project Report*. As the inquiry log is a personal document, students can decide whether it is a digital or hard copy record of their work. As a personal document, the inquiry log is not submitted to the SEC.

Stage 1: Considering the brief

In stage 1, students focus on consideration of the Applied Geography Project brief from the SEC. It is envisaged that this stage will take up to 1 hour.

The brief from the SEC will contain a geographical theme related to learning outcomes in the Leaving Certificate Geography specification. The theme will be the focus of the Applied Geography Project.

Teachers may decide to facilitate a class-based discussion on the theme of the brief to support students in considering initial ideas and planning. Teachers and students may find it useful to consider the following prompts:

- How can I better understand the geographical nature of the theme?
- What do I already know about the theme?
- What geographical questions do I have about the theme?
- How can I apply the theme to a geographical focus that I find interesting?
- How does the theme present itself in the geography of my local area?
- How will I record my approach and project work in my inquiry log?

In their interactions with students at this early stage, teachers have an opportunity to become familiar with students' understanding of the brief. Classroom discussion about the feasibility of students' initial ideas and planning, potential inquiry limitations, and possible amendments or adaptations to overcome limitations are important elements in stage 1. Facilitating students to connect the theme with a local geographical focus or setting may assist with reducing any inquiry limitations.

For the teacher, an initial exploration of the brief will lead to the identification of relevant Leaving Certificate Geography learning outcomes that relate to the theme. It will inform and support planning for the future integration of relevant learning in class. In addition, teacher consideration of the theme will identify relevant geographical inquiry-related issues and opportunities that may be appropriate to discuss with students.

Stage 2: Formulating the inquiry question

In stage 2, students complete background reading relevant to the focus of or setting for their Applied Geography Project and formulate an overarching inquiry question for their project. It is envisaged that this stage should take 3-4 hours.

Background reading is an important aspect of the Applied Geography Project as this provides students with more information about the theme and supports them to formulate their inquiry

question. Students should read from appropriate and reliable sources, which might include textbooks, published works by academic researchers, data published by government bodies, reports by public bodies, etc. In stage 2, students may encounter sources that can be revisited in stage 4.

While doing their background reading, students should use their inquiry log to record useful and relevant information and data and keep track of the relevant sources. Students must cite their sources (see Appendix 2).

When students finish their background reading, they should work independently to formulate their overarching inquiry question and sub-questions. The inquiry question must be directly related to the theme outlined in the brief from the SEC. The purpose of the sub-questions is to break down the inquiry question into smaller, more manageable questions. Responses to the sub-questions can collectively serve to support the students' response to the overarching inquiry question. Where possible, students are strongly encouraged to consider a local geographical focus or setting. This will assist in ensuring a manageable and feasible Applied Geography Project.

The students' inquiry question will frame their Applied Geography Project, meaning that the question will support them to determine the specifics of their inquiry. The inquiry question should act as an anchor that they will consistently return to when making decisions about planning and conducting their inquiry, analysing and communicating findings, and when evaluating and reflecting.

Students must ensure that their inquiry question:

1. is relevant to the theme in the brief
2. makes evident *what* the inquiry is attempting to find out
3. makes evident *where* the inquiry is located, that is the setting for the inquiry.

The following prompts may be helpful to support students in formulating an inquiry question:

- Is my inquiry question relevant to the theme? In what way?
- Have I considered the geographical questions of who, what, when, where, why and how?
- Is my inquiry question clear about what I am trying to find out?
- Is the location or setting for the inquiry clearly identified in my question?
- Where will I find evidence (geographical data and information) to respond to my inquiry question?
- What appropriate sources of information will be useful?
- What geographical inquiry methods (desk-based and fieldwork) are appropriate for this theme?
- Given the time and resources available for the Applied Geography Project, is my inquiry question feasible and manageable? If not, how does the inquiry question need to change?

- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

During this stage, teachers should review students' inquiry log relating to stage 2. This will support in the authentication process (see 'Role of the teacher' pages 12-13).

Stage 3: Considering evidence collection

In stage 3, students work independently to consider the evidence (geographical data and/or information) needed to respond to their inquiry question and the methods required to collect this evidence. It is envisaged that this stage should take between 2-3 hours.

Depending on the inquiry question, evidence may take different forms. Students are required to gather their own primary sources of evidence and work with secondary sources. While some secondary sources of evidence may be consulted during stage 2, students can use other appropriate and reliable secondary sources in stage 4 and afterwards as needed.

Decisions about the best method of evidence collection are an important aspect of the Applied Geography Project. Depending on the students' inquiry question, the geographical information and/or data collected may be qualitative or quantitative or a combination of the two. Each student's decisions regarding gathering methods will also be informed by their prior experiences of using and learning about a variety of collection methods in different settings, both in and beyond the classroom.

During stage 3, students must consider how to ensure that their chosen collection method will produce evidence that is both reliable and accurate. The potential for bias must be considered, and plans must be made to minimise its impact.

Stage 3 is an appropriate point to consider whether there is a benefit to engaging with geospatial datasets in some way to fulfil the requirements of the brief. For example, by gathering locational data for where data and/or information is collected and plotting this on a map during stage 5 (analysing and interpreting findings). Students could also engage with geospatial data collected by others to find out more about their geographical focus, in their chosen setting or other relevant setting.

The following prompts may be helpful in supporting students in considering the evidence to be gathered:

- What type of evidence (data and/or information) do I need to respond to my inquiry question?
- Does my preferred collection method require desk-based research or fieldwork?
- Do I need to use quantitative, qualitative or a mixture of quantitative and qualitative methods to gather this evidence?
- Do I have prior experience of gathering evidence using this method(s)? If not, how do I find out more about this method(s)?
- Is the approach I am considering manageable and realistic?
- How will I avoid bias and ensure reliability and accuracy in the evidence I collect?

- What, if any, are the data protection, ethical and safety considerations I need to think about?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Students must consult with their teacher around the manageability, feasibility, adaptability, flexibility, viability of the approach chosen before beginning to gather their geographical evidence. It is expected that most work will be completed in the school setting under the supervision of the teacher. If the project involves carrying out tasks outside of school hours or beyond school grounds, students should ensure they have all necessary permissions and abide by all ethical and safety guidelines agreed in consultation with the school. All student work must be authenticated by the teacher through oversight of work done in school and ongoing review of any work completed outside of school hours or beyond school grounds.

Stage 4: Collecting evidence

Informed by work completed in previous stages, in stage 4 students focus on collecting the evidence needed to respond to their inquiry question. It is envisaged that this stage should take between 6-8 hours; however, the time required will depend on the approach chosen by the student.

All students must collect their own evidence, and their evidence must not be shared with peers. Students should provide sufficient and satisfactory detail and evidence to ensure that their teacher can authenticate that they collected their own evidence.

Evidence does not need to be collected at a single point in time and may be collected on more than one occasion from appropriate primary or secondary sources. Any evidence gathered should ensure privacy and comply with relevant data protection regulations. The entire process involved in completing the Applied Geography Project will be subject to the school's data protection protocols, including General Data Protection Regulations (GDPR).

When students are collecting evidence that involves the operation of equipment which requires more than one person, they can work together. In such cases, each student must take an active role in generating the evidence that contributes to responding to their individual inquiry question. A single collection method may produce evidence relevant to the inquiry question of multiple students', but all participating students must remain engaged and responsible for the evidence they intend to use.

The following prompts may be helpful to support students in their collection of evidence:

- Have I collected enough appropriate and accurate evidence to respond to my inquiry question?
- Do I need to gather more evidence or adapt my evidence collection approach to get the necessary evidence?
- Has the process of collecting evidence highlighted a need to revise my inquiry question?

- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Stage 5: Analysing and communicating

In stage 5, students will focus on analysing and communicating all the evidence collected and sourced. It is envisaged that this stage should take between 2-3 hours.

Students should use different formats to present their evidence. This particularly applies where data is available. Possible formats include charts, graphs, tables, maps or diagrams. The formats chosen must be appropriate to the specific evidence. Students should justify the formats they use.

When analysing, students break down the data and/or information they have gathered to find relationships, patterns or trends. When interpreting, students determine what their analysis means in response to their inquiry question, and how these findings relate to the theme in the brief. The evidence and related findings are then communicated in appropriate formats such as in writing, diagram, graphically, or other relevant format and can be included as appropriate in the students *Applied Geography Project Report*.

The following prompts may be helpful to support students in analysing and communicating their evidence:

- Have I used different formats to present my evidence?
- What, if anything, surprises me about my findings?
- Do my findings help me respond to my inquiry question?
- Have I used appropriate formats to communicate my evidence and findings?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Stage 6: Evaluating evidence and reflecting on findings

In stage 6, students focus on evaluating their evidence and reflecting on their findings. It is envisaged that this stage should take between 1-2 hours.

In evaluating their evidence, students will consider the accuracy and reliability of how their evidence was collected and reflect on whether there was any bias in the approach taken. Students should have already considered bias in the thinking about their method of collective evidence (stage 3), but in stage 6 there is further opportunity to evaluate whether bias is evident in their evidence or has played a role in their collection methods.

In reflecting on their findings, students consider the broader significance of their findings. This will include consideration of the interactions, interconnections and implications of their findings and how their findings relate to or can be applied to geographical focus or settings other than those in the student's own inquiry.

The following prompts may be helpful to support students in evaluating their evidence:

- Did the methods I used to collect evidence ensure reliability and accuracy? What might have further improved reliability and accuracy?
- Did the evidence I collected lead to the findings I expected or not? That is, did it support me to respond to my inquiry question? Why/why not?
- How significant are my findings? Can my findings be connected or applied to other geographical inquiries, for example, inquiries with a different focus or setting?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during the evaluating evidence and reflecting on findings stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Stage 7: Finalising the *Applied Geography Project Report*

Having engaged with stages 1-6 outlined above, in this stage students focus on finalising and submitting a digital *Applied Geography Project Report*. It is envisaged that this stage should take up to 1 hour.

Assessment of the Applied Geography Project is based solely on the students' individual *Applied Geography Project Report*. It is envisaged that the suggested prompts provided in stages 1-6 will support students to refine and reflect upon their work, and to maintain their inquiry log, which in turn will be useful in generating their *Applied Geography Project Report*.

The *Applied Geography Project Report* should provide an authentic account about the students' engagement with the Applied Geography Project. In finalising their digital *Applied Geography Project Report*, students should ensure that it complies with all requirements of the brief.

Format and Submission of the Applied Geography Project

Students will be required to develop and submit an *Applied Geography Project Report* as part of their Applied Geography Project. The *Applied Geography Project Report* will be presented in a digital format prescribed by the State Examinations Commission (SEC).

All work completed as part of the Applied Geography Project must be concluded by a set date. This date will be set by the SEC and communicated to schools and will also be included in the brief that issues in Term 2 of Year 1 of the course.

The *Applied Geography Project Report* must be submitted in line with instructions provided by the SEC. These instructions will contain specific information, such as the word count, number of images permissible, the required structure and section headings, file size, etc.

Students may choose to support, clarify or provide evidence of either the process or outcomes of their Applied Geography Project through the use of images such as illustrations, sketches, graphs, charts, tables, photographs, etc.

Students are required to engage in referencing to acknowledge the use of any work included in their project that is not their own. Details on referencing and using references can be found in Appendix 2.

It is extremely important that all of the work submitted by students for assessment is their own. The submission of work by any candidate not entirely completed by that candidate is a significant breach of regulations. Submitting such work may lead to the imposition of penalties, up to and including the withholding of related results.

A robust authentication process is central to ensuring the integrity of any assessment process. School-based authentication by teachers of students' work on their AAC is essential to the fair and equitable assessment of that work. While it is neither practicable nor necessary for teachers to witness all aspects of students' work, teachers need to be satisfied that students have carried out the work themselves. Regular, comprehensive engagement with each student's work on their AAC will enable teachers to confidently and legitimately authenticate any work being submitted for assessment.

The SEC provides detailed guidance on the authentication of coursework and the conditions for its acceptance. Information as to how this applies in the case of the Applied Geography Project will be provided in the brief, and also in other documentation which may be issued by the SEC.

Descriptors of Quality

The descriptors below relate to the learning achieved by students in the Applied Geography Project. In particular, the project requires students to engage with:

- planning and conducting their inquiry

- analysis and communication
- evaluation and reflection.

Table 2: Descriptors of quality: Applied Geography Project

	Students demonstrating a high level of achievement	Students demonstrating a moderate level of achievement	Students demonstrating a low level of achievement
Planning and conducting their inquiry	engage thoroughly with relevant concepts. Consider and engage effectively with a wide range of data. Choose and effectively employ data collection methodologies that are appropriate and justified.	have good engagement with relevant concepts. Consider and engage with a range of data. Choose and employ data collection methodologies that are appropriate with some effectiveness.	have limited engagement with concepts. Consider and engage in a limited manner with a range of data. Have poorly chosen data collection methodologies that are employed with limited effectiveness.
Analysis and communication	engage in detailed analysis of their findings. Communicate throughout in the most clear and comprehensive way, using consistent and coherent language. Employ geographical terminology appropriately and relevantly. Present clear and appropriate data, information, and analysis, using a range of relevant graphics as appropriate.	engage in analysis of their findings. Broadly communicate in a clear and extensive way throughout, for the most part, using moderately consistent and coherent language. Employ some geographical terminology appropriately and relevantly. Present adequate data and information and analysis, using relevant graphics as appropriate.	engage in little to no analysis of their findings. Are largely unclear and limited in their communication, using inconsistent and incoherent language. Seldom employ geographical terminology or do so in a way that is inappropriate and irrelevant. Present limited data and information and analysis, with limited or no use of graphics.
Evaluation and reflection	engage in considered evaluation and reflection throughout the project and have a detailed consideration of how their findings apply in a context other than the focus of their inquiry.	engage in some evaluation and reflection throughout the project and have some consideration of how their findings apply in a context other than the focus of their inquiry.	engage in limited evaluation and reflection at times during the project and have limited consideration of how their findings apply in a context other than the focus of their inquiry.

Role of the teacher

The teacher has an important role to play in supporting and supervising student work on the Applied Geography Project. Teaching and learning related to the additional assessment component should be integrated into ongoing classroom practice to maximise opportunities for students to achieve the learning outcomes of the specification and support the development of key competencies.

The release of the common brief by the SEC in term two of year one allows teachers to signpost the requirements and content of the brief from an early stage of learning in the subject. It will also facilitate teachers in planning for the integration of the AAC, as appropriate, into the natural flow of teaching and learning in the classroom.

Support may include:

- clarifying the requirements of the Applied Geography Project brief
- helping students to understand how the brief issued by the State Examinations Commission for the Applied Geography Project links to the Leaving Certificate Geography specification
- identifying any particular areas of the specification that students may need to engage with in order to undertake the AAC
- ensuring students are aware of the descriptors of quality associated with the AAC
- offering prompt questions, such as those supplied in stages 1-7 (repeated in Appendix 1), to stimulate and support students' planning and critical thinking throughout the process
- encouraging students to focus on the requirements of the brief and to relate their work to the learning outcomes in the specification
- guiding students in the continued development of their inquiry skills
- helping students to appreciate the importance of good referencing practices and the necessity to avoid any form of plagiarism
- facilitating access to appropriate resources
- providing appropriate access arrangements for students with additional learning needs, in accordance with the State Examinations Commission provision of reasonable accommodations
- making students aware that they must comply with any relevant mandatory regulations or requirements such as those relating to health and safety, General Data Protection Regulations (GDPR), accessing public or private property etc.
- using feedback appropriately to promote a reflective approach to work on the AAC
- providing instructions at strategic intervals to facilitate the timely completion of the AAC

- drawing students' attention to any requirements in relation to the submission of the AAC specified in the brief
- promoting opportunities afforded by the AAC to develop senior cycle key competencies.

In order to facilitate the authentication process, teachers should engage regularly with students' work on the AAC. Teachers should be aware that only work which is the student's own can be submitted for assessment to the State Examinations Commission and that each student must submit their work on an individual basis. Where more than one student within a class is working on a similar Applied Geography Project, it is important that each student takes an individualised approach to the work.

The feedback provided to students should be general and nondirective in nature. Teachers should not provide any excessive or inappropriate support to students, such as editing draft work or providing model text or answers to be used in the students' evidence of learning.

Appendix 1: Suggested prompt questions to support students in the process for completion of the Applied Geography Project

Considering the brief

- How can I better understand the geographical nature of the theme?
- What do I already know about the theme?
- What geographical questions do I have about the theme?
- How can I apply the theme to a geographical focus that I find interesting?
- How does the theme present itself in the geography of my local area?
- How will I record my approach and project work in my inquiry log?

Formulating the inquiry question

- Is my inquiry question relevant to the theme? In what way?
- Have I considered the geographical questions of who, what, when, where, why and how?
- Is my inquiry question clear about what I am trying to find out?
- Is the location or setting for the inquiry clearly identified in my question?
- Where will I find evidence (geographical data and information) to respond to my inquiry question?
- What appropriate sources of information will be useful?
- What geographical inquiry methods (desk-based and fieldwork) are appropriate for this theme?
- Given the time and resources available for the Applied Geography Project, is my inquiry question feasible and manageable? If not, how does the inquiry question need to change?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Considering evidence collection

- What type of evidence (data and/or information) do I need to respond to my inquiry question?
- Does my preferred collection method require desk-based research or fieldwork?
- Do I need to use quantitative, qualitative or a mixture of quantitative and qualitative methods to gather this evidence?
- Do I have prior experience of gathering evidence using this method(s)? If not, how do I find out more about this method(s)?
- Is the approach I am considering manageable and realistic?
- How will I avoid bias and ensure reliability and accuracy in the evidence I collect?

- What, if any, are the data protection, ethical and safety considerations I need to think about?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Collecting the evidence

- Have I collected enough appropriate and accurate evidence to respond to my inquiry question?
- Do I need to gather more evidence or adapt my evidence collection approach to get the necessary evidence?
- Has the process of collecting evidence highlighted a need to revise my inquiry question?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Analysing and communicating

- Have I used different formats to present my evidence?
- What, if anything, surprises me about my findings?
- Do my findings help me respond to my inquiry question?
- Have I used appropriate formats to communicate my evidence and findings?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during this stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Evaluating evidence and reflecting on findings

- Did the methods I used to collect evidence ensure reliability and accuracy? What might have further improved reliability and accuracy?
- Did the evidence I collected lead to the findings I expected or not? That is, did it support me to respond to my inquiry question? Why/why not?
- How significant are my findings? Can my findings be connected or applied to other geographical inquiries, for example, inquiries with a different focus or setting?
- Using my inquiry log, have I documented the decisions I made during the evaluating evidence and reflecting on findings stage, including the reasons for these decisions?

Appendix 2: Guidelines to support referencing

Referencing is an important aspect of the AAC as it allows those reading the <insert relevant term> to better engage with the content and to verify the information provided in the reference. It is the most appropriate way for students to acknowledge the source of any information, ideas, material or images not their own which they have included in their AAC.

Referencing allows students to provide evidence of the research they have engaged in, it helps to support and give weight to arguments and conclusions, and it can be used to demonstrate that different perspectives have been considered and explored by the student.

Students should engage in referencing both within the body of their work (in-text citation) and also in the reference section of the <insert relevant term>. The use of in-text citation provides a direct link between what students write and the research on which their work is based.

Example:

A student using material from page 57 of the book *Inclusion: effective practice for all students?* would use the in-text citation (p. 57, McLeskey, 2013) and then go on to also add details to the list of references as McLeskey, J. (2013) *Inclusion: effective practice for all students?* 2nd edn.

In the reference section of their document, students should provide the appropriate details of any sources they have used during the course of their <INSERT AAC TITLE> such as:

- books, newspapers, magazines
- professional journals and government reports
- online sources including videos, podcasts etc.
- material from specialist organisations and relevant individuals
- material generated by artificial intelligence (AI) software and AI applications. Specific information will be issued around this in the AAC brief and in related documentation from the SEC.

The reference section is not included in the word count. Comprehensive referencing helps to show that students have engaged in honest and ethical research practices and have avoided plagiarism. Referencing should be as specific as necessary to communicate the particular research source, such as a page number or chapter in a book, a section in a website, timestamp on a podcast or video etc.

Plagiarism is a serious offence and occurs when work other than the student's own is used without clear acknowledgement of the source of the work. This includes the use of material generated using artificial intelligence (AI) software or AI applications. Direct copying of material from any source without proper acknowledgement is not permitted and may incur penalties, up to and including the withholding of related results.

When referencing the sources students used in their <insert relevant term> they should ensure that, regardless of the type of source, there is enough accurate detail to enable the reader to authenticate the reference. No particular, formal style of referencing is required.

How students should reference different sources

- Where students are citing written sources or information in print, they should give the author's name, the title of the publication, year of publication, and, if necessary, the page number or chapter/section of the publication.
- Where students wish to refer to an internet site or online source, there should be enough accurate detail to enable the reader to authenticate the reference, including the hyperlink and date read or downloaded.
- Where students have used material generated by artificial intelligence (AI) software and AI applications this must be acknowledged. The reference should include the name of the AI tool used; the date the content was generated and provide a brief explanation of how it was used. Many Generative AI tools generate shareable URLs that set out the content of chat sessions that took place. Where such a tool has been used, the URL should be included in the list of research sources. Where an AI tool does not generate a sharable URL, student should include the name of the tool and the prompt used.

Examples of in-text Citations for different types of sources
Book: (p. 57, McLeskey, 2013)
Newspaper/magazine article: (Hearne, J., 30/08/2024)
Text/image accessed online: (thelatinlibrary.com/101/RhetoricalDevices)
Audio accessed online: (Ep. 10, rte.ie/radio/podcasts/22093250)
Video accessed online: (3:20 to 5:45, youtu.be/yCv4iyPqZKQ)
AI Tools (with shareable url): (chat.openai.com/share/f45a1e23-2217-4443-a244-d56ab26ae940)
AI Tools (without shareable url): (OpenAI (2023) ChatGPT, 20/10/2023)

Examples of references for different types of sources
Book in list of references: McLeskey, J. (2013) <i>Inclusion: effective practice for all students?</i> 2nd edn.
Newspaper/magazine article Hearne, J. (30/08/2024) 'How bad driving habits cost Irish motorists hundreds every year', Irish Examiner
Text/image accessed online Latin Library, Principal Rhetorical and Literary Devices, (date written not available), http://www.thelatinlibrary.com/101/RhetoricalDevices.pdf , Date accessed: 17/6/24
Audio accessed online Philip Boucher Hayes, RTE, Hot Mess – Megawatts and Megabytes, Podcast, date created: 30/5/24, https://www.rte.ie/radio/podcasts/22093250-ep-10-megawatts-and-megabytes/ , Date accessed: 10/11/23
Video accessed online ApintTurtle, Zig & Zag – Christmas crises, Film, date created 20/12/2008, http://youtu.be/yCv4iyPqZKQ , 12/12/14, from 3 minutes 20 seconds to 5 minutes 45 seconds.
AI Tools Example with shareable URL generated by the AI Tool: OpenAI (2023) ChatGPT (Oct. 20 version) [Large language model], accessed 20 October 2023. https://chat.openai.com/share/f45a1e23-2217-4443-a244-d56ab26ae940
AI Tools Example without shareable URL OpenAI (2023) ChatGPT (Oct. 20 version) [Large language model], accessed 20 October 2023. Prompt used and text generated.

Other guidelines have included appendices on aspects such as

- Templates for completion of aspects/stages of the process outlined above
- Useful links to appropriate resources
- Prompts/prompt questions for students to consider.



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